First-30-Days Takeover Checklist

Property: _____ **Date:** _____

Part G: Own it.

Takes in: the closed deal and your diligence file.

Hands to: AS-26 (tenant playbook), AS-30 (the 90 and 365 reviews).

Closing is not the finish line. It is the day you inherit every promise the seller ever made to every tenant and vendor. This checklist turns the transaction into an operation, in order, without month-one chaos.

1. Day 0: before the money moves

- [ ] Keys, gate codes, and every password the manager holds. Collected, not promised.
- [ ] Insurance binder in your name, effective at closing. No binder, no close.
- [ ] Bank account in the park's name. Rent flows to you from day one.
- [ ] Security deposits transferred and documented, dollar for dollar.
- [ ] Ownership-change notices filed: water and wastewater permits, park license, operator transfers. Many jurisdictions have deadlines. Check yours.
- [ ] "If it was not in the purchase agreement, it does not exist." Walk the agreement line by line.

2. Days 1 to 7: money, insurance, rent flow

- [ ] Confirm every tenant's payment now points at you. Tenants still paying the old owner is a day-one leak.
- [ ] Pay the vendors the seller stiffed, then put every vendor on your terms.
- [ ] Walk every lot. The diligence walk was a census; this one is your baseline.
- [ ] Send the new-owner letter (kit below). One letter, every door, same day.

3. Days 8 to 30: set the culture

- [ ] Quick trust wins first: fix the pothole, return every call within 24 hours. Trust wins are separated from value wins on purpose.
- [ ] Reissue the rules with the attorney's sign-off. State law varies; your lease and state law control the timing.
- [ ] Start the rent-increase logic (AS-26): which lots, how much, what notice. Attorney checks before any notice goes out.
- [ ] Value wins queued, not rushed: rent normalization, billing changes. Trust first, leverage second.

Front continues on page 2: days 31 to 365, the tenant communication kit, the ten-number Baseline Sheet, and the day-30 review.

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4. Days 31 to 90: the first quarter

- [ ] Quarterly lot walk. Compare to the day-one baseline, not to memory.
- [ ] Delinquency review: the escalation runs on your watch now. Timing is rule of thumb, verify locally; your lease and state law control it.
- [ ] Reserve refresh: is the reserve line still funded after quarter one?

5. Days 91 to 365: the first-year rhythm

- [ ] Quarterly walks, every quarter. Annual reserve refresh. This is the rhythm now.
- [ ] Day-365 review against the Baseline Sheet. That review feeds the next deal's Normalizer (AS-08).

6. Tenant communication kit

New-owner letter (fill-ins): your name, the park's name, where rent goes now, who to call, what changes and what does not. One page, plain words.

- [ ] Rules reissue: same rules, your name on them, attorney reviewed.
- [ ] Rent-increase notices: logic first, attorney second, notice third. Never the reverse.

New-owner letter sent (date): _____ **Rules reissued (date):** _____

7. Baseline Sheet: ten numbers, captured at close

Number	At close	Day 90	Day 365
Occupied lots (of total)			
Average rent collected per occupied lot			
Delinquency ($ behind)			
Monthly expense run rate			
Utility cost per lot per month			
Open work orders			
Insurance annual premium			
Property tax (reassessed)			
Reserve balance			
Debt service (monthly)			

8. Day-30 review: underwriting vs reality

Compare what happened to what the Normalizer assumed. The gap is tuition. Write it down so the next deal's underwriting is smarter.

Assumed monthly collections ($): ____ **Actual ($):** _____ **Gap ($):** _____

Biggest surprise: _____ **What it changes next time:** _____

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Worked example: Maple Bend Estates (fictional)

Fictional close on a fictional park. Seeds: 48 lots, 41 occupied, deposits $189,000, seller expenses $71,000. Fictional close date December 1, 2026. Seed-derived rows are shown; the rest get filled at the real close.

Baseline number	At close (checked)
Occupied lots	41 of 48 = 85.4% (walk-verified)
Average rent per occupied lot	$15,750 / 41 = $384.15 per month
Monthly expense run rate	$71,000 / 12 = $5,916.67
Monthly collections (realized)	$189,000 / 12 = $15,750
Utility cost per lot per month	Fill from the first full utility bills
Open work orders	Fill at close: the walk list becomes this list
Insurance annual premium	Fill at close: your binder, not the seller's
Property tax (reassessed)	Fill at close: assessor's number post-sale
Reserve balance	Fill at close: 6 months of operating costs, rule of thumb, verify locally
Debt service (monthly)	Fill at close: the signed note

Day-30 review, filled (fictional month one)

Assumed monthly collections: $15,750. Actual: $15,200 (fictional). Gap: $550. Biggest surprise: three of the 41 occupied lots pay late every month; the manager's "on time" claim failed the Verify One check (AS-12). What it changes next time: price late-payer history into the first-quarter reserve, not just the rent.

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The Doctrine

The belief this checklist shatters is that closing is the finish line. Closing is the starting line with a mortgage. On closing day you inherit every promise the seller ever made to every tenant and every vendor, and the diligence file you built is the only honest record of what you bought. Acquisition and operation are the same discipline: verify, write it down, re-measure. The one rule: the Baseline Sheet gets filled at close and re-measured at 90 and 365 days, no exceptions, because memory lies and the sheet does not. The rite of passage is the day you send the first letter to the residents and sign your name as the owner. That is when you stop being a buyer and become a steward of a community.

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